

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 30 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Ten • Relationships & Connections

OVERVIEW

Stage Ten's thirty FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Friendships & Peer Connections, Project Partners & Teamwork, and Mentorship & Professional Connections. Each session pairs short facilitator framing with individual reflection and, for several FIRSTS, genuine real-world action taken outside the session itself (sending a message, having a real conversation, scheduling a real meeting).

This stage asks for more real, external follow-through than most others — many FIRSTS genuinely can't be completed inside the session (you can't have a real mentor conversation live in a workshop). Expect a higher proportion of “launch it here, complete it after” exercises than in more skills-based stages.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Friendships & Peer Connections — N1–N10	~110 min
Session 2	Project Partners & Teamwork — N11–N20	~110 min
Session 3	Mentorship & Professional Connections — N21–N30	~115 min

SESSION 1

Friendships & Peer Connections

Covers FIRSTS N1–N10: Genuine Friendship Formed, Peer Support Exchange, Fun/Relaxation Activity with Friends, Conflict Resolution with a Friend, Appreciation Note to a Friend, Reflection on Friendship Qualities, Networking through Friendships, Collaborative Study Session, Trust-Building Exercise, Group Celebration or Milestone Recognition.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring to mind one real friendship they'd genuinely like to invest in more deliberately, and one real, unaddressed tension in a friendship (for later use in FIRST N4).

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: relationships are a practiced skill, not just something that happens to you	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST N1 — Genuine Friendship Formed: identify one relationship to invest in	Solo
0:30–0:45	FIRST N2 — Peer Support Exchange: plan a specific offer/ask	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST N3 — Fun/Relaxation Activity: plan one genuine activity	Solo
1:00–1:05	Short break	—

1:05-1:25	FIRST N4 — Conflict Resolution with a Friend: plan a real conversation	Solo
1:25-1:40	FIRST N5 — Appreciation Note: draft and send one	Solo, live sending encouraged
1:40-1:55	FIRST N6 — Reflection on Friendship Qualities	Solo
1:55-2:10	FIRSTS N7-N8 — Networking through Friendships + Collaborative Study Session	Solo
2:10-2:25	FIRST N9 — Trust-Building Exercise + N10 — Group Celebration: framing + close	Solo, then full-group discussion

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST N4 (Conflict Resolution) can surface genuine emotion — give it real room rather than rushing to the next FIRST, and don't require anyone to share specifics of their conflict with the group.
- FIRST N5 works well as a live-send exercise if participants have their phones — sending the note during the session, not just drafting it, closes the loop completely.
- Several FIRSTS here (N1, N4, N7) genuinely can't be fully completed inside the session; frame them explicitly as launched today, followed up on independently.

SESSION 2

Project Partners & Teamwork

Covers FIRSTS N11–N20: Project Partner Identified, Task Delegation Practice, Team Goal Alignment, Collaborative Problem-Solving Session, Peer Feedback Exchange, Accountability Partner Agreement, Group Reflection & Debrief, Conflict Mediation in a Team, Recognition of Team Contributions, Leadership or Facilitation Role in a Group.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one current or upcoming group project they can reference throughout this session, ideally a real one with a real partner or team already in place.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + bridge: friendships run on trust and care; teams add a shared task on top of that	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST N11 — Project Partner Identified: evaluate genuine fit	Solo
0:25–0:45	FIRST N12 — Task Delegation Practice: plan an open, fair division	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST N13 — Team Goal Alignment: draft a confirmation approach	Solo
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:25	FIRST N14 — Collaborative Problem-Solving Session	Pairs, if a real partner is present
1:25–1:40	FIRST N15 — Peer Feedback Exchange: plan a mid-project checkpoint	Solo
1:40–1:55	FIRST N16 — Accountability Partner Agreement: draft specifics	Solo
1:55–2:10	FIRSTS N17–N18 — Group Reflection & Debrief + Conflict Mediation	Solo
2:10–2:20	FIRSTS N19–N20 — Recognition of Contributions + Leadership Role + close	Solo, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- If any participants are genuinely working together on a real shared project, pair them for FIRST N14 — it's far more valuable live than done solo.
- FIRST N18 (Conflict Mediation) should stay hypothetical or reflective for most participants unless a real, current conflict is safe to discuss; don't force disclosure of an active team conflict in front of the group.
- FIRST N20 (Leadership Role) works well as a forward commitment — have participants name one specific upcoming opportunity to lead, not just reflect on past ones.

SESSION 3

Mentorship & Professional Connections

Covers FIRSTS N21–N30: Mentor Identified, Mentor Meeting Scheduled, Thoughtful Question to a Mentor, Follow-Up with Mentor, Peer Networking Circle Formed, Industry Contact Made, Coffee Chat with a Professional, Volunteer Collaboration, Peer Recommendation Given, Reflection on Relationship Growth.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to think of one person, even a tentative guess, who could serve as a genuine mentor — someone with relevant experience and plausible willingness to invest time.
- This is the final session of the stage; let participants know they'll close with a full-stage reflection, not just a session-level one.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: mentorship and professional networks are relationships too, built the same deliberate way as Sessions 1 and 2	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST N21 — Mentor Identified: evaluate genuine fit over prestige	Solo
0:25–0:35	FIRST N22 — Mentor Meeting Scheduled: draft a specific request	Solo, live sending encouraged
0:35–0:50	FIRST N23 — Thoughtful Question to a Mentor: prepare tailored questions	Solo
0:50–1:00	FIRST N24 — Follow-Up with Mentor: plan the follow-up in advance	Solo
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:20	FIRST N25 — Peer Networking Circle Formed: plan structure	Solo, or small group if forming one together
1:20–1:35	FIRSTS N26–N27 — Industry Contact + Coffee Chat: framing + plan outreach	Solo
1:35–1:50	FIRSTS N28–N29 — Volunteer Collaboration + Peer Recommendation Given	Solo
1:50–2:15	FIRST N30 — Reflection on Relationship Growth + full-stage close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRSTS N21–N24 form a connected arc; if time is tight, they can be worked through together as one continuous block rather than four fully separate segments.
- FIRST N30 is a full-stage reflection, not just a Session 3 wrap-up — explicitly ask participants to look back across friendships, teamwork, and mentorship together.
- Close by having each participant name one specific relationship (a friendship, a team relationship, or a mentor connection) they're committing to invest in further after this program.